

Home entertainment consoles

- **What?** Sony PlayStation 2
- **Who?** Sony, Ken Kutaragi
- **Where and when?** Japan, 2000

Another Japanese company, Sony, entered the video game industry in the 1990s. Its first console, the PlayStation, was released in 1994 and was reasonably successful. The real game changer was its follow-up, the PlayStation 2. This could also play DVDs and CDs, making it an all-in-one home entertainment console.



Controller vibrates with onscreen action.

It would become the biggest selling home console of all time, with more than 150 million shipped.

Motion control

- **What?** Nintendo Wii
- **Who?** Nintendo
- **Where and when?** Japan, 2006

Despite intense competition from Sony and Microsoft, Nintendo enjoyed major success in the 2000s with its Wii console, which

helped to popularize controlling the game using your motions. This technology allows gamers to use their remote control as virtual sporting equipment to play games such as tennis, golf, and boxing.

Player moves the controller to direct the action on screen.

Console and computer

- **What?** Xbox
- **Who?** Microsoft
- **Where and when?** US, 2001

After years of Japanese domination, the US reentered the market in a big way in 2001 with the launch of the powerful Xbox. The streaming service of its successor (Xbox One) allows gamers to play Xbox games remotely on their computer.



Xbox game played on a laptop